

Useful prompts for Copilot in Excel

Intro to Copilot in Excel | Updated September 25, 2026

Start with the task and its location

Name the sheet or columns, explain the result, and state what should stay unchanged. For a larger task, review a plan before editing.

Format a small worksheet

Make this worksheet easier to read. Format population with thousands separators and no decimals, size with one decimal, and adjust column widths. Preserve the underlying values.

Create a formula

On products, add Size (cups) using an Excel formula. Size is in US fluid ounces. Use 8 fluid ounces per cup and keep the original columns.

Ask for an explanation

Explain the Size (cups) formula in plain language. Identify its input and explain the conversion factor.

Build a report

Using sales, create a Sales Summary sheet with total_sales by year and month, a native editable Excel line chart, and totals by product_category. Preserve the source sheet. Use ordinary Excel formulas or PivotTables.

Refine the result

Sort the category summary by sales descending. Add each category's percentage of total sales and format the results appropriately.

Check it in Excel

Inspect a formula, compare a total to the source, and check the dates and units. Test a changed input, then restore it. Confirm whether charts are editable and whether PivotTables need Refresh.

Choose the mode

Chat only for a question. Plan for an approach. Allow editing for workbook changes. If a request is too broad, split it into smaller steps.

Microsoft references

[Prompting and AutoSave](#)

[Copilot modes and capabilities](#)